They claim that we are directly aware of objects made up of real physical atoms. Past and future ***dharmas*** exist if cognitions have real things as their objects. When there is an object, there arises a cognition. When there is no object, no cognition arises. If there were neither past nor future ***dharmas***, there would be cognitions with unreal objects as their objective supports (***alambana***). But that is impossible. If there were no past or future ***dharmas***, there would be no cognitions of past or future ones because of this lack of objective support. And if there were no past ***dharmas***, how could there be future consequences of good or bad ***karma***? How could there be the coming to fruition of past ***karma*** in the present?

Actualisation in the present moment is the exercise of a ***dharma***'s effective activity (*karitram*). This efficacy is conditioned by and conditions other atomic factors. It means that a ***dharma*** is replaced by one of a similar kind. That the atoms pre-exist and continue to exist albeit in another dimension explains the continuities that we experience.

The most fertile source of information about this school is ***Vasubandhu***'s *Abhidharmakoshabhashya*.

See ***Abhidharma***, ***Pratyaya***

Further reading: Potter 1996; Pruden 1988

Vaidharmya-drishtanta see ***Hetu*** and ***Vipaksha***

Vaisheshika: one of the six orthodox Hindu philosophical outlooks (*darshanas*), this school is concerned with mapping the basic types of constituents and structures (***padartha***) of the universe. It was intimately associated with the ***Nyaya*** tradition, with which it eventually coalesced. The basic text is the *Vaisheshika-Sutra*, dating from about 100 CE, which is explained by *Prashastapada* (c. 500 CE) in the *Padarthadharmasamgraha*. *Vyomashiva*